

Data Request: Ormat Technologies – Steamboat Hills Field

Steamboat Hills Geothermal Outflow Monitoring – UNR Thesis Project

2026-09-25

Project background

This request supports a University of Nevada, Reno thesis project studying changes in geothermal outflow at Steamboat Hills, Nevada, following the June 2025 Lower Sinter Terrace eruption – including remapping springs Ormat reports as inactive, and comparing current chloride discharge to Michael Sorey’s historic (1988-2017) estimates. We have built a consolidated well/chemistry/monitoring database for the field from public sources (NDEP, NDWR, NDOM, NBMG, USGS) and Dhakal et al. (2025)’s own published flow-network diagram, but several real gaps remain that only Ormat, as the field operator, would be positioned to fill.

What we are requesting

#	Request	Why it matters
1	Real coordinates and/or confirmed identities for the following wells named in Dhakal et al. (2025)’s Figure 5 flow diagram or Table 1, currently unresolved in our database: PW2-2, PW2-4, IW-2, IW-3, 21-5R, 13-5R, 21B-5R, 83B-6R, COX-1	These are named, real wells in Ormat’s own published flow network – we have exhausted public NBMG/NDWR records trying to locate them (a naming-scheme coincidence with an unrelated Ormat well field in Churchill County has already been ruled out for PW-1/2/3).

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2	Current or historic water levels for Ormat's own production, injection, and monitor wells within the field	The single biggest blocker to a real potentiometric surface for the Steamboat field – public records (NDEP, NDWR) do not carry this for actively-operated wells.
3	Whether Ormat would permit, or already collects, any chemistry/temperature sampling at the capped Lower Sinter Terrace wellhead and the adjacent steaming fissure (active since June 2025)	This is a genuinely novel, real end-member close to the active eruption vent – directly relevant to whether the 2025 event represents a change in the deep upflow itself, not just a surface reconfiguration.
4	Confirmation of which port(s) (Galena 1/2/3, SB2/3, SBHR) feed which of the still-ambiguous injection wells not shown in the 2024 Figure 5 snapshot (e.g. IW-2, IW-3, both reported Idle/Plugged & Abandoned)	Needed to keep our production -> port -> injection flow-network model current and accurate as operations change.

What we can offer in return

A copy of the consolidated database export (GeoPackage, suitable for direct use in ArcGIS) covering the public well/chemistry/monitoring record we have already assembled for the field, and any results from our own spring-remapping and Cl-discharge fieldwork this thesis produces.

Contact

Please direct any response to [Tyler Irvin / UNR contact information].